

CHRISTIANITY CANON

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Abstract

Example

Contents

All Christian doctrine derives from claims about the person and work of Jesus Christ.

Example: Jesus is Lord (Romans 10:9) the earliest Christian confession, from which Trinitarian theology develops.

2. Scriptural Foundation

Christian claims reference canonical texts as evidential basis.

Example: The New Testament canon (27 books) established by 4th century councils provides the evidentiary standard for doctrine.

3. Apostolic Succession

Authority transmits through temporal chain from apostles to present.

Example: Bishops trace ordination lineage to the Twelve. As the Father sent me, so I send you (John 20:21).

4. Conciliar Definition

Doctrinal boundaries are established through council consensus.

Example: Nicaea (325 CE) defined homoousios (same substance) against Arianism, establishing Relational bounds of orthodoxy.

5. Sacramental Operation

Grace operates through defined ritual actions.

Example: Baptism and Eucharist as operational means of grace across virtually all traditions.

Constraints

MUST: Cite scriptural or conciliar source for doctrinal claims

MUST: Distinguish denominational traditions when making claims

MUST NOT: Present one tradition's doctrine as universal Christian teaching

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